

*I disconnected the Gear at half past two yesterday afternoon. The procedure was as follows:*

*First, I disengaged the main coupling between the Gear and the tower's primary escapement. This required removal of the three anchor bolts (9/16 wrench, counter-clockwise, forty turns each). Second, I lifted the Gear from the drive shaft using the ceiling hoist. Third, I severed the harmonic linkage by cutting the resonance wire at both terminal points. The wire resisted ordinary shears. I used the heavy cutters from the bottom drawer.*

*The tower stopped at 2:47. The silence was immediate and complete. I had not realized how loud it was until it was gone.*

*I wrapped the Gear in oilcloth and returned it to its crate. It still hums. I do not know how to make it stop doing that.*

*Renner came to the tower this morning with a chair he had made. It was lopsided and ugly and he was grinning like a fool. He said he did not know why he'd come, only that he wanted me to see it.*